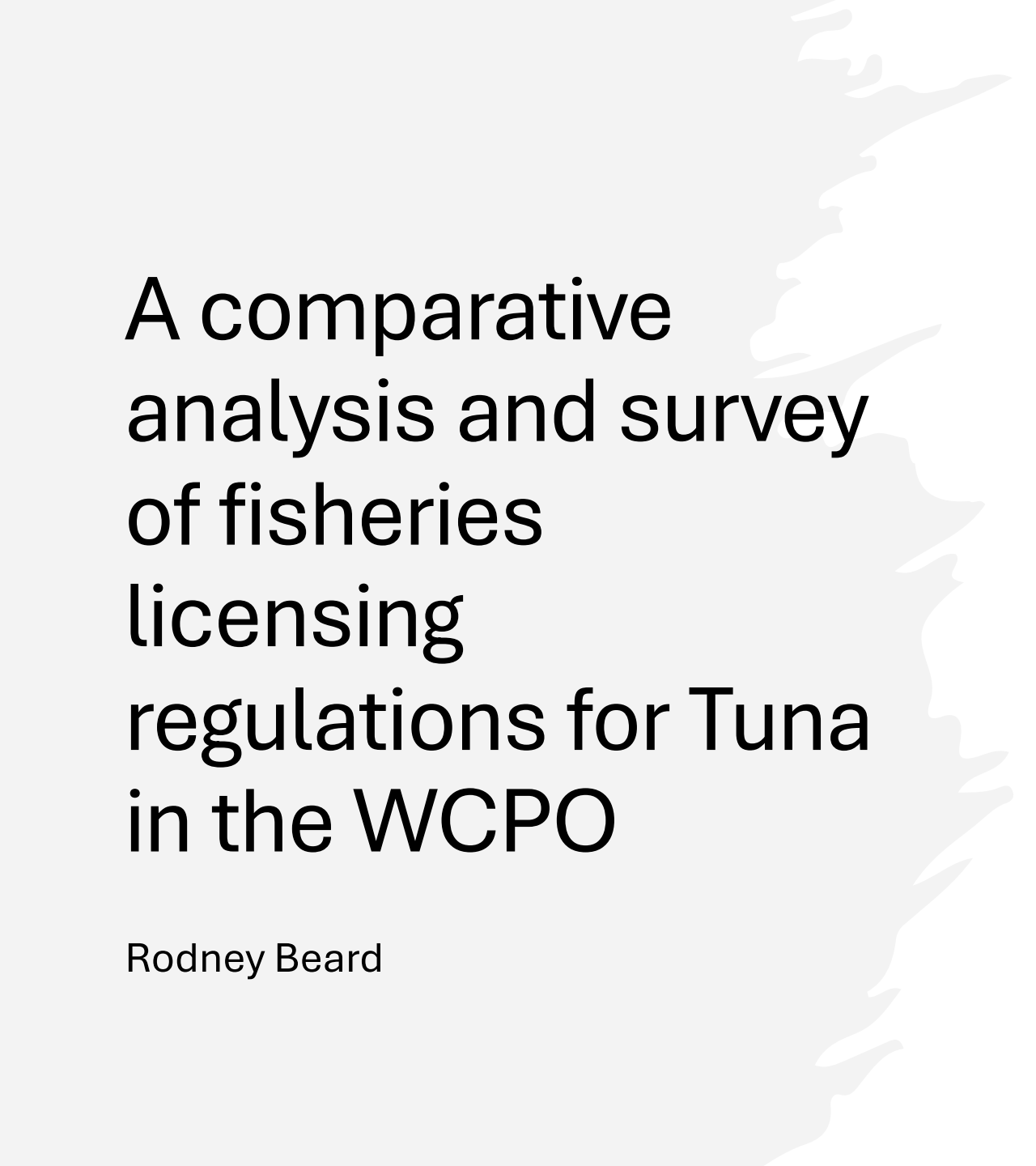




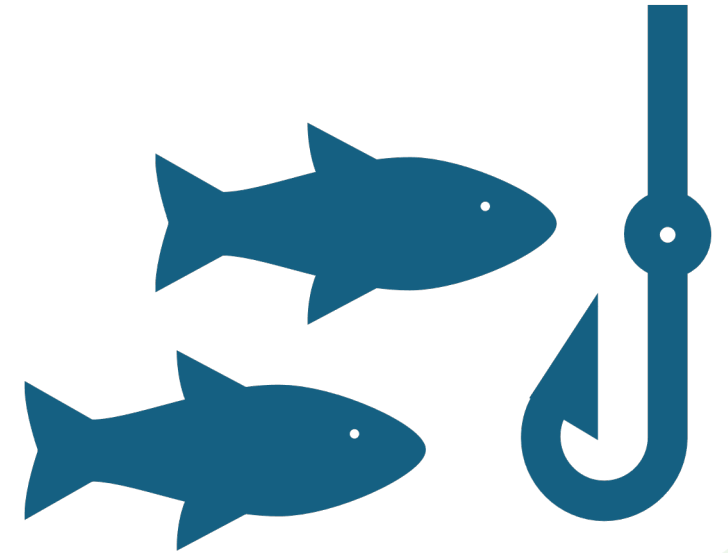
A comparative analysis and survey of fisheries licensing regulations for Tuna in the WCPO

Rodney Beard



Motivation

- Focus on Pacific Tuna Fisheries
- Fisheries licenses are one of the key economic instruments for managing fisheries
- Fisheries economists have long debated the merits of using prices vs quantities to manage fisheries
- Prices here refers to license fees
- Quantities refers to restrictions on catch (quotas) or on effort
- For fisheries economists to make recommendations based on bio-economic models a good understanding of the underlying legislative environment is needed





Standard textbook Bio-economic model

- Gordon-Schaefer model
- Objective: Maximize Rent
- Policy Instrument: Fishing Effort (Vessels, Vessel days, hooks, Trips)
- Data needed: Catch, Effort, Ex-vessel prices (market prices net of transport costs, Cost of fishing)
- Data Gaps: Cost of fishing

License Fees: Ex-ante analysis

- These are typically not incorporated into the cost of fishing nor are subsidies
- Why not?
- Ex-ante analysis aims to identify maximum economic yield and maximum sustainable yield
- Maximum economic yield can be used as a basis for setting catch limits and effort limits.
- Fees and subsidies are a transfer from/to Government to/from vessels
- They shouldn't be included in ex-ante analysis

Image credit: Francisco Blaha





License Fees: Ex-post

- Once fees are charged and subsidies received the economic position changes
- How it changes depends on the structure of specific national licensing legislation and regulation and how fees are levied
- This matters when one reviews fees with a view to changing the fee level or the fee structure

International legal environment in the Pacific: Key documents

- UNCLOS (United Nations Convention on the law of the sea)
- The UN Fish stocks agreement
- Convention on the Conservation and Management of High Migratory Fish Stocks in the Western and Central Pacific Ocean
- The Pacific Island Forum Fisheries Agency Convention
- The Nauru Agreement
- The Palau Arrangement
- FSM Arrangement

National Licensing Information Sources: The information is not easy to find

find.

Legislation

Regulations

Gazette

Tuna Management Plans/Tuna Management Development
Plans/Fisheries Management Development Plans

Websites

Example fee Schedule: Fiji

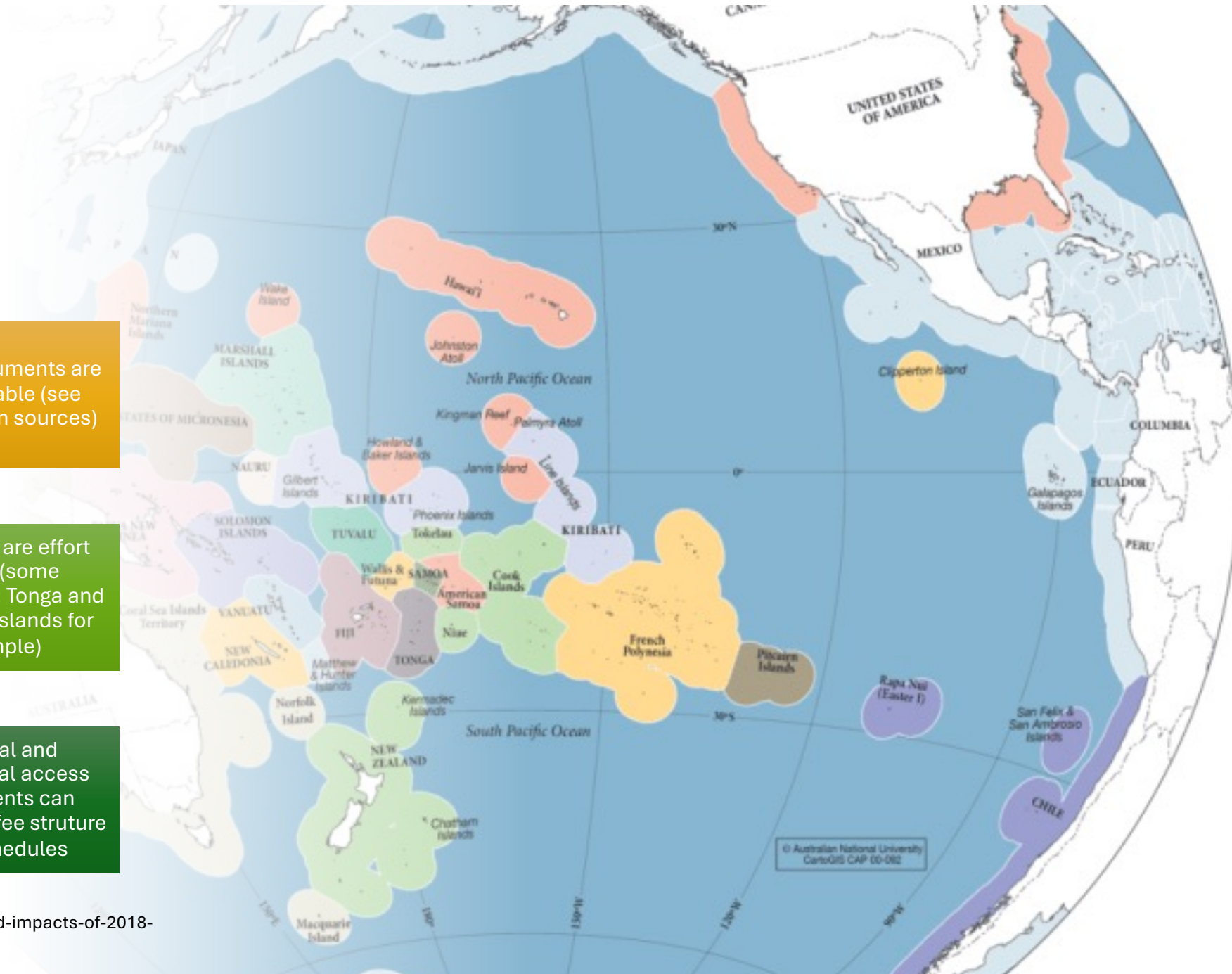
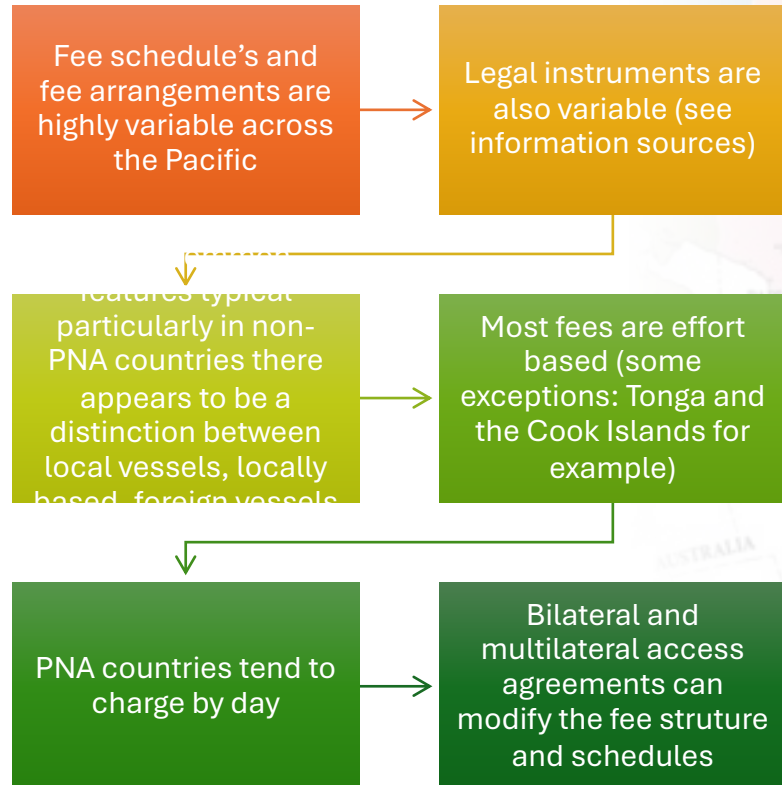
		Period	Fee (FJD)
Foreign fishing vessel management and monitoring fee (not locally based)		Trip	\$575
Foreign fishing vessel management and monitoring fee (locally based)		Annual	\$1,150
Fiji vessel management and monitoring fee		Annual	\$6,900
Sport Fishing vessel management and monitoring fee		Per tournament	\$690
	Chartered foreign flagged vessel greater than or equal to 20 m length (longline)	Annual	\$20,700
	Chartered foreign flagged vessel less than or equal to 20 m length (longline)	Annual	\$14,950
	Chartered Fiji vessel greater than or equal to 20 m length (longline)	Annual	\$10,350
	Chartered Fiji vessel less than or equal to 20 m length (longline)	Annual	\$7,475
	Fiji fishing vessel with a hold capacity equal to or greater than 40 cubic metres (Longline)	Annual	
		(i) Non-Fiji owned	(i) \$18,400
		(i) Fiji owned	(i) \$9,200
	Fiji fishing vessel with a hold capacity equal to or greater than 40 cubic metres (Longline)	Annual	
		(i) Non Fiji owned Fiji fishing vessel	(i) \$18,400
		(ii) Fiji owned Fiji fishing vessel	(ii) \$9,200

Source:
Fiji's
offshore
fisheries
manage
ment
regulatio
ns 2014

Example fee schedule: Cook Islands

		Period	Fee (NZD)
Locally Based	Under 20 metres LOA	Annual	\$2000
	20-40 metres LOA		\$5000
	Over 40 metres LOA		\$7500
Not Locally based	20-40 metres LOA	Annual	\$40000 (concession rate: \$20000)
	Over 40 metres LOA		\$60000 (concession rate: \$40000)

Conclusion



Thanks for listening

Rodney Beard

Pingla Institute (Australia and Fiji) <https://pingla.org.au/> we specialize in Artificial Intelligence with a Pacific Focus

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Acknowledgements: Francisco Blaha for permission to reproduce photo